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Notifications

Loading...

Building agents for real-world challenges

AI that doesn't just
provide answers—it
helps you take action.

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Google Cloud Rapid Agent Hackathon

Building Agents for Real-World Challenges

[Edit project](#)

[Create project](#)[Import from portfolio](#)**Who can participate**

- Above legal age of majority in country of residence
- Specific countries/territories excluded ⓘ
 - Team max size: 4 Eligible Individuals

[View full rules](#)

14 more days to deadline

[View schedule](#)**Deadline**Jun 12, 2026 @ 12:00am [GMT+3](#) ✎

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Online



Public

[\\$60,000 in cash](#) 11636 participants[Google](#)[Managed by Devpost](#) ⓘ[Databases Machine Learning/AI Open Ended](#)**About the challenge**

AI that doesn't just provide answers—it helps you take action.

Building Agents for Real-World Challenges is your opportunity to move beyond the chatbot and into the world of **agents that accomplish tasks for you**. This hackathon is designed for every level of technical builder: whether you are writing your first script or architecting complex systems, this is your chance to build an **agent** that can reason, plan, and execute tasks under your oversight.

Built with Gemini's advanced reasoning and our technology partners' solutions, you will create agents that **help people get more done**. You provide the logic; Gemini provides the brain; our partners provide the **superpowers**.

Turn your ideas into agents that solve real-world problems.

Partners

Six partner tracks are now live. Pick one and build with their MCP server:

- [Arize](#)
- [Elastic](#)
- [Fivetran](#)
- [GitLab](#)
- [MongoDB](#)
- [Dynatrace](#)

The "Partner Bucket" System

There are three identical prize buckets—one for each of our featured partner tracks. Instead of everyone competing for one giant pile of money, you are competing within the specific "bucket" of the partner technology you used.

Prize Tier Amount (Per Partner Bucket): 🏆 **1st Place** \$5,000 🥈 **2nd Place** \$3,000 🥉 **3rd Place** \$2,000

How to Qualify

1. **Pick a Partner:** Choose the partner technology that best fits the mission you want to accomplish.
2. **Build Your Agent:** Create your agent—built with Gemini 3—using Google Cloud Agent Builder. Integrate the partner's Model Context Protocol (MCP) server to give your agent the superpowers to finish the job.
3. **Win Your Track:** You'll be judged specifically against other builders within that same partner category.

Examples of challenges your agent can solve:

2026 World Cup: Build an agent that solves a real-world challenge for the 2026 World Cup! Whether your agent automates fan logistics, assists local businesses in managing tourist surges, or powers a fully automated fantasy league, we want to see how AI can elevate the beautiful game.

Financial Services: Build an agent that solves a real-world problem in the financial sector! Whether your agent automates real-time fraud detection, streamlines complex loan workflows, or executes personalized wealth management, we want to see how AI can drive precision and trust in the modern economy.

Brick-and-Mortar Retail: Build an agent that solves a real-world challenge for brick-and-mortar malls! Whether your agent provides real-time shopper navigation, automates hyper-local tenant campaigns, or streamlines facility operations, we want to see how AI can bridge the gap between digital convenience and physical retail.

Requirements

The Challenge

Your mission is to engineer a functional agent that solves a real-world challenge—specifically targeting your work, personal life, hobbies, or daily routines. We want to see how AI can tackle real-world problems.

Your Goals:

- **Move Beyond Chat:** Your agent shouldn't just answer questions. It should use tools and capabilities to accomplish tasks (e.g., managing a local database, automating a hobbyist workflow, or interacting with a live web service).
- **The Multi-Step Mission:** Build a system that can handle complex goals. Your agent should be able to plan the steps and use the tools at its disposal to finish the job, while keeping you in control.
- **Partner Power:** Your solution must demonstrate a meaningful integration with at least one participating partner's solution using MCP to give your agent its "superpowers."

How to Build:

- **Google Cloud Agent Builder:** Ideal for rapid prototyping, building, and scaling. Use this low-code, high-power environment to build and orchestrate agents with grounding in your own data.

What to Build

✦ Build a functional agent—powered by Gemini and Google Cloud Agent Builder—that integrates a Partner Entity's MCP server to solve a real challenge.

What to Submit

- Include a URL to the hosted Project
- Include a URL to your open-source code repository for judging and testing.
 - *The repository must be public and include a complete open source license file. This license should be detectable and visible at the top of the repository page (in the About section)*
- Include a ~3 minute demo video
- Select which track you'll be submitting to
- Your completed Devpost submission form

Hackathon Sponsors

Google Cloud

 **arize**

 **elastic**

 **Fivetran**

 **GitLab**





Prizes

\$60,000 in prizes

Arize - 1st Place

\$5,000 in cash
1 winner

Elastic - 1st Place

\$5,000 in cash
1 winner

Arize - 2nd Place

\$3,000 in cash
1 winner

Elastic - 2nd Place

\$3,000 in cash
1 winner

Arize - 3rd Place

\$2,000 in cash

1 winner

Elastic - 3rd Place

\$2,000 in cash
1 winner

Fivetran - 1st Place

\$5,000 in cash
1 winner

GitLab - 1st Place

\$5,000 in cash
1 winner

Fivetran - 2nd Place

\$3,000 in cash
1 winner

GitLab - 2nd Place

\$3,000 in cash
1 winner

Fivetran - 3rd Place

\$2,000 in cash
1 winner

GitLab - 3rd Place

\$2,000 in cash
1 winner

MongoDB - 1st Place

\$5,000 in cash
1 winner

Dynatrace - 1st Place

\$5,000 in cash
1 winner

MongoDB - 2nd Place

\$3,000 in cash
1 winner

Dynatrace - 2nd Place

\$3,000 in cash
1 winner

MongoDB - 3rd Place

\$2,000 in cash
1 winner

Dynatrace - 3rd Place

\$2,000 in cash
1 winner

Devpost Achievements

Submitting to this hackathon could earn you:



First online hackathon



↑ level 1



Hackathon Winner

↑ level 1



Generalist

Judges



Richard Young
Director of Partner Solutions | Arize



Clay Miner
Head of Solutions Strategy | Arize



Anish Mathur

Director of Product Management | Elastic



Philipp Krenn

Director, Developer Relations | Elastic



Elijah Davis

Lead Solution Architect, Enterprise | Fivetran



Andrew Madson

Principal, Developer Relations | Fivetran



Regnard Raquedan

Senior Solutions Architect | GitLab



Nick Veenhof

Director, Contributor Success | GitLab



Daoud Farooqi

Partner Solutions Architect | MongoDB



Gaurab Aryal

Senior Product Manager | MongoDB



Sean O'Dell

Principal PMM, Developer Experience | Dynatrace



Jeff Blankenburg

Principal Developer Advocate | Dynatrace



Khushan Adatiya

Senior Software Engineer | Google



Rich Deken

Cloud Partner Engineer, Global Business | Google



Jess Ambriz

Cloud Partner Engineer, Global Business | Google



Jon Pawlowski

Partner Engineer III, ISV, Data Management | Google



Saurabh Kumar

ISV Partner Engineer, Global Business | Google



George Keller

Cloud Partner Engineer, Global Business | Google



Merlin Yamssi

Lead Solutions Consultant, Cloud Partner Engineering | Google

Judging Criteria

- **Technological Implementation**
Does the interaction with Google Cloud and Partner services demonstrate quality software development?
- **Design**
Is the user experience and design of the project well thought out?
- **Potential Impact**
How big of an impact could the project have on target communities?
- **Quality of the Idea**
How creative and unique is the project?

Looking for a team?

Browse [Participants](#) or chat on [Discord](#) to find teammates.

Find teammates on Discord 

To-dos

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Questions? [Email the hackathon manager](#)

Invite others to compete

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Google Cloud

 **arize**

 **elastic**

 **Fivetran**

 **GitLab**



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P.S. Ensure your status is set to Looking for teammates.

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